NIGRAH Scam Family Taxonomy Framework (SFTF v1)

Purpose

The Scam Family Taxonomy Framework provides the classification layer of NIGRAH.

While Threat Signals identify individual warning indicators and Manipulation Patterns identify behavioral attack mechanisms, Scam Families represent the operational forms through which fraud reaches investors.

This framework transforms scattered scam incidents into structured intelligence.

TAXONOMY STRUCTURE

We should not classify scams based on platform.

Wrong:

```
WhatsApp Scam
Telegram Scam
Instagram Scam
```

Platforms change.

Behavior remains.

Instead, classify based on:

```
Fraud Objective
+
Manipulation Pattern
+
Execution Method
```

This makes the framework future-proof.

CATEGORY A

AUTHORITY-BASED FRAUDS

Frauds where trust is borrowed from a perceived authority.

SF-01

Fake SEBI Advisor Fraud

Description:

Scammer claims SEBI registration, regulatory approval, or official recognition.

Primary Patterns:

- Authority Exploitation
- Identity Manipulation

Threat Vector:

```
[10,7,3,2,4,5,2,2,10,1]
```

Threat Level:

Very High

SF-02

Fake Research Analyst Fraud

Description:

Fake market experts provide recommendations and advisory services.

Primary Patterns:

- Authority Exploitation
- Greed Engineering

Threat Level:

Very High

SF-03

Fake Portfolio Manager Fraud

Description:

Unauthorized PMS services promising wealth management.

Primary Patterns:

- Authority
- Trust Harvesting

Threat Level:

Very High

SF-04

Celebrity / Finfluencer Impersonation Fraud

Description:

Fake profiles impersonating known financial influencers.

Primary Patterns:

- Authority
- Social Validation
- Identity Manipulation

Threat Level:

High

CATEGORY B

RETURN-PROMISE FRAUDS

Frauds centered around unrealistic gains.

SF-05

Guaranteed Return Scam

Description:

Promises fixed profits regardless of market conditions.

Primary Patterns:

- Greed Engineering

Threat Level:

Critical

SF-06

High Return Investment Scheme

Description:

Promises extraordinary returns within short durations.

Examples:

- 5x return
- 10% monthly return

Primary Patterns:

- Greed
- Pressure

Threat Level:

Critical

SF-07

Double Money Scheme

Description:

Investor is promised capital multiplication.

Primary Patterns:

- Greed

Threat Level:

Critical

SF-08

Daily Income Trading Scheme

Description:

Regular income promised from market activity.

Primary Patterns:

- Greed
- Trust

Threat Level:

High

CATEGORY C

SIGNAL & TIP FRAUDS

Frauds built around privileged information.

SF-09

Telegram Signal Group Fraud

Description:

Paid groups providing stock tips and signals.

Primary Patterns:

- Greed
- Social Validation

Threat Level:

Very High

SF-10

WhatsApp Tip Group Fraud

Description:

Investment recommendations through private groups.

Primary Patterns:

- Social Proof
- Pressure

Threat Level:

High

SF-11

Insider Information Scam

Description:

Claims access to confidential market information.

Primary Patterns:

- Authority
- Information Asymmetry

Threat Level:

Very High

SF-12

Pump-and-Dump Scheme

Description:

Artificial hype followed by coordinated selling.

Primary Patterns:

- Greed
- Social Validation
- Network Expansion

Threat Level:

Critical

CATEGORY D

DIGITAL PLATFORM FRAUDS

Frauds delivered through digital infrastructure.

SF-13

Fake Trading Application

Description:

Fake apps displaying fabricated profits.

Primary Patterns:

- Identity Manipulation

- Financial Entrapment

Threat Level:

Critical

SF-14

Clone Broker Platform

Description:

Fake copies of legitimate broker websites.

Primary Patterns:

- Identity Manipulation

Threat Level:

Critical

SF-15

Fake Investment Website

Description:

Website impersonates a financial institution.

Primary Patterns:

- Authority
- Identity Manipulation

Threat Level:

Very High

SF-16

Deepfake Advisor Scam

Description:

AI-generated videos and voices used to gain trust.

Primary Patterns:

- Authority
- Identity Manipulation

Threat Level:

Emerging Critical

CATEGORY E

PONZI & PYRAMID FRAUDS

Frauds dependent on continuous recruitment.

SF-17

Classic Ponzi Scheme

Description:

Returns paid using new investor money.

Primary Patterns:

- Greed
- Social Validation

Threat Level:

Critical

SF-18

Referral Pyramid Scheme

Description:

Participants earn by recruiting others.

Primary Patterns:

- Network Expansion

Threat Level:

Critical

SF-19

MLM Investment Fraud

Description:

Investment product disguised as a network business.

Primary Patterns:

- Network Expansion
- Trust Harvesting

Threat Level:

Very High

CATEGORY F

TRUST-HARVESTING FRAUDS

Frauds that develop relationships before extracting money.

SF-20

Mentor Scam

Description:

Scammer builds personal relationship before pitching investments.

Primary Patterns:

- Trust Harvesting

Threat Level:

High

SF-21

Premium Membership Scam

Description:

Exclusive community promised superior returns.

Primary Patterns:

- Exclusivity
- Social Validation

Threat Level:

High

SF-22

Investment Coaching Scam

Description:

Education used as a funnel toward financial exploitation.

Primary Patterns:

- Trust Harvesting
- Authority

Threat Level:

High

CATEGORY G

EXIT & RECOVERY FRAUDS

Frauds occurring after money is already invested.

SF-23

Withdrawal Restriction Fraud

Description:

Investor prevented from accessing funds.

Primary Patterns:

- Financial Entrapment

Threat Level:

Critical

SF-24

Recovery Scam

Description:

Victims promised recovery of previous losses.

Primary Patterns:

- Authority
- Trust

Threat Level:

Critical

SF-25

Tax Release Scam

Description:

Additional fees demanded before withdrawal.

Primary Patterns:

- Entrapment

Threat Level:

Critical

SF-26

Verification Fee Scam

Description:

Extra charges demanded for account verification.

Primary Patterns:

- Entrapment

Threat Level:

High

CATEGORY H

OPPORTUNITY FRAUDS

Frauds exploiting exclusive investment opportunities.

SF-27

Fake IPO Scam

Description:

False access to IPO allocations.

Primary Patterns:

- Scarcity
- Greed

Threat Level:

Very High

SF-28

Fake Pre-IPO Opportunity

Description:

Claims access to private placements.

Primary Patterns:

- Exclusivity

Threat Level:

Very High

SF-29

Unlisted Share Scam

Description:

Fraudulent sales of non-tradable securities.

Primary Patterns:

- Information Asymmetry

Threat Level:

High

SF-30

Alternative Asset Fraud

Description:

Fake investments in commodities, crypto, forex, etc.

Primary Patterns:

- Greed
- Complexity

Threat Level:

High

FAMILY INTELLIGENCE MODEL

Now every scam family has:

```
Family ID
Family Name
Primary Patterns
Threat Vector
Threat Index
Historical Harm
Growth Rate
Regional Distribution
Detection Confidence
```

Example:

```
{
  "family_id": "SF-13",
  "name": "Fake Trading App",
  "threat_index": 94,
  "growth_rate": 8.7,
  "severity": 9.8,
  "confidence": 0.91
}
```

Why This Taxonomy Matters

At this point NIGRAH now has:

Layer 1

Threat Signals

(25 Signals)

↓

Layer 2

Manipulation Patterns

(10 Patterns)

↓

Layer 3

Scam Families

(30 Scam Families)

↓

Layer 4

Threat Index

(Not Built Yet)

↓

Layer 5

Prediction Engine

(Not Built Yet)